COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WAX, GENERAL PURPOSE, SOLVENT TYPE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification P-W-158.

This description covers two types and classes of general purpose solvent waxes. The waxes are intended primarily for use on wooden or cork floors, but may be used on painted or sealed wood floors, terrazzo, ceramic, marble, and tile. They are not recommended for use on asphalt, vinyl or rubber composition floor tiles.

The wax shall be of the following types and classes:

Type I - Liquid
Class 1 - Without Silica
Class 2 - With Silica

Type II - Paste

Salient characteristics.

Types I and II wax shall consist of natural or synthetic waxes or a mixture thereof dissolved or dispersed in a volatile organic solvent consisting of turpentine or volatile petroleum distillates or a mixture thereof, suitable for application at 18° to 30° C (64° to 86° F). Type I wax shall be a homogeneous free-flowing liquid and type II shall be a soft, homogeneous paste.

Chemical characteristics.

	Type I				Type II		
	Class 1		Class 2				ASTM
Characteristics	min.	max.	min.	max.	min.	max.	Test Methods
Silica, percent	-	-	1.5	1.7	-	-	1/
Nonvolatile content, percent	11.0	-	10.0	-	20.0	-	D2834
Cone penetration, at 30° C	-	-	-	-	60	140	D217
Flash point of solvent, °C	38		38		38		D56

1/ Silica content. Weigh a 10-gram sample into a pre-ignited and tared platinum crucible. Add sufficient ashless cotton to absorb the sample and ignite slowly at first over a Meker burner. Place in a muffle furnace at 800° C for 30 minutes. Cool, desiccate, and weigh. This is the weight of ash. Moisten the residue with 1 to 2 ml. of water, add 4 to 5 drops of sulfuric acid

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(1 part acid- 2 parts water) and approximately 5 ml. of hydrofluoric acid. Evaporate to SO_3 fumes and finally ignite, cool, desiccate, and reweigh.

$$\text{Percent silica} = \frac{\text{Loss in weight (weight of ash - final weight) x 100}}{\text{Sample weight}}$$

Performance characteristics. The waxes, when used in accordance with directions for use, shall produce a lustrous surface, free from tackiness, streaks, or smears, and be resistant to soiling and detergents.

Physical characteristics. The waxes shall be free of grit or abrasive matter, and Types I and II shall be dry to the touch at the end of 15 and 20 minutes, respectively.

Stability. For type I, fill stoppered graduated 100-ml cylinder with a uniform sample and leave undisturbed for 24 hours, at 30 ± 1° C. Then allow the sample to stand an additional 24 hours at 25 ± 1° C and determine the degree of settling. Separation should be less than 5 percent. For type II, examine the sample of paste wax after standing in a closed container at 30 ± 1° C for 24 hours followed by 24 hours at 25 ± 1° C. There shall be no separation of solvent from the wax.

The issue of ASTM D 56, 217, and 2834 in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with stated requirements.

Regulatory requirements. Labeling data shall be in accordance with the Federal Hazardous Substance Act Regulations 16 CFR 1500.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order. Each container label shall include directions for use.

NOTES. Purchaser should specify type and class.

The ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTEREST:

None

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA - FSS, PBO
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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